

ENTREPRENEURIAL PULSE



E-club APIIT

apiit_eclub



SUMMER WITH APIIT



AS this month's primary project, the Entrepreneurship Club had the pleasure of hosting our fellow students from Staffordshire University on a unique educational excursion! As part of the Summer with APIIT exchange program, 26 students explored Sri Lanka's vibrant culture and educational landscape. Our club took the initiative, guiding them through the captivating halls of the Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art (MMCA) located in the heart of Colombo 03. This architectural gem offered a glimpse into Sri Lanka's post-colonial architectural niche, sparking curiosity and discussion on yet another aspect of Sri Lanka.



The MMCA experience wasn't just about the physical space. We arranged a special movie screening that delved deeper into the artistic narratives showcased within the museum's walls. While the artistic styles might not have resonated with everyone, the overall experience proved to be a valuable one, fostering open discussions and a broader appreciation for artistic expression. The Club was represented by President Vidussh Gunasekera, Vice Presidents Amana Ekanayake and Kavindu Wannisinghe, Secretary Dewdun Jayakody, Treasurer Himidiri Wickramabahu, and Events Lead Madhumitha Balajeyandhan.



We at the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo believe that exposure to diverse perspectives and experiences is a crucial aspect of personal and professional growth no matter what dynamic field you hail from as there is always opportunity to learn and grow. This exchange program served as a testament to that belief, and we're thrilled to have played a part in enriching the Sri Lankan experience for our Staffordshire counterparts!



Applications for the committee are out now! With openings for 23 positions, we aim to engage with our club members as much as possible. While deadlines do close on the 30th of June, stay tuned and excited for our biggest project as it unfolds into a national level competition with the best schools in Sri Lanka participating in the grand Sandbox Shield.



SANDBOX

Keep an eye out on our socials for more information , and watch as the magic unfolds!

PROJECT SANDBOX

WHAT IS SANDBOX

A one of a kind project, dubbed Sandbox, will be the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo's signature project for the years 2023/2024, replacing Startup Summit of the 2022/2023 committee. This project, which will take place in August 2024, will mark the Entrepreneurship Club's entry into school - level competitions, with Sandbox taking place in the form of an interSchool business pitching competition. Chaired by Vice President Kavindu Wannisinghe, Treasurer Himidiri Samintha, and President Vidussh Gunasekera, this competition will follow the theme of **sustainability** to mark the importance of the ever-rising issue of the climate crisis and its effect on our planet.

CLUB ORIENTATIONS



AS

a new set of students joined APIIT for the July 2024 intake, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT took part in the club orientations that took place on the 27th and 28th of June at the different APIIT campus premises. The first orientation took place on the 27th of June at City Campus premises for Business and Computing Foundation students and later for Law Foundation students at Law School, represented by the President, Vice President, and Secretary.

Day 02 focused on Business, Computing, and Law undergraduate students, where the President, Vice President, and Treasurer took students on a journey of what the Entrepreneurship Club was, its aims and goals, the journey so far, and the advantages of joining the club. With interactive videos on what the club was up to over the year, the club saw over 50 new members join, marking a momentous milestone of progress.



STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

AMANYA EKANAYAKA

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Tea-Licious is a unique and refreshing beverage experience. Each tea is carefully brewed and infused with natural ingredients to offer a burst of flavor in every sip. Whether you're looking to cool down on a hot day or simply enjoy a delicious drink, my iced teas are the perfect choice

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

My entrepreneurial spirit was sparked during my time as a Barista at Food Studio Colombo City Center. I loved the hustle of the food industry and always had this vision of starting my food chain someday. During the COVID lockdown, I seized the opportunity to deepen my knowledge with online courses in entrepreneurship and marketing, which fueled my ambition.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

The biggest challenge so far has been dealing with the initial drop in orders when I first launched. It was a tough moment that tested my confidence and decision-making. But from that experience, I learned resilience and the importance of persistence in pursuing your dreams, even when things don't go as planned.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

Running my venture gives me a sense of control and the freedom to innovate. Sure, there are ups and downs—every business has them. The initial drop in orders scared me, but it also taught me valuable lessons about market dynamics and customer engagement.



4. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

The most helpful resources for me have been online courses, especially during the lockdown, which provided me with essential knowledge in digital marketing and entrepreneurship. Additionally, networking with fellow entrepreneurs and mentors through online communities has been invaluable for advice and support.

5. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

Marketing my business has been a blend of social media engagement on Instagram and TikTok, targeted online ads, and collaborations with influencers who resonate with my brand. These strategies have helped me reach my target audience effectively.

6. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5–10 years?

Ultimately, I hope my business can make a positive impact by offering quality products and creating memorable experiences for customers. In 5–10 years, I envision expanding into a food chain known for its unique offerings and excellent customer service.

7. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Any tips for others?

Balancing studies with running a business is all about effective time management. I've learned to prioritize tasks and allocate specific times for studying and business operations. My tip for fellow student entrepreneurs would be to create a schedule and stick to it, but also be flexible enough to adapt when unexpected challenges arise.

8. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

My top piece of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs is: First, embrace failure as a learning opportunity. Second, stay adaptable in a rapidly changing world. And third, always prioritize customer satisfaction—it's the key to sustainable growth. What keeps me motivated? Seeing my vision slowly take shape and knowing that every setback is a stepping stone to success.

9. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey?

While I haven't had formal mentors or advisors, I've relied on my own research, networking, and learning from industry trends. It's been a journey of self-discovery and self-reliance, which has its challenges but also its rewards in personal growth.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired? What keeps you motivated and inspired?

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11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

Looking back, I wouldn't change a thing about starting my entrepreneurial journey as a student. The challenges have been tough, but they've also been incredibly rewarding in terms of personal and professional growth. The most enjoyable part has been seeing my ideas come to life and making a tangible impact through my business.



THE IMPORTANCE OF ENTREPRENEURS

BY MOHAMMED AZWER FATHIMA SHAHEENA



Embarking on the journey of entrepreneurship requires more than just a business idea; it demands a unique mindset, unwavering determination, and a willingness to navigate through challenges. In this article, we delve into the essence of entrepreneurship, examining the opportunities it presents, the hurdles entrepreneurs often face, and the profound impact they have on society. From defining the traits of successful entrepreneurs to showcasing the latest innovations in the field, this exploration aims to inspire aspiring business leaders and shed light on the dynamic landscape of entrepreneurship.

An entrepreneur is like a magician of ideas, turning dreams into reality with a sprinkle of hard work and resilience. Their characteristics include creativity, adaptability, and a healthy appetite for risk-taking. Having a growth mindset is like fuel for entrepreneurs, it's the belief that ability can be developed through dedication and hard work. In the entrepreneurial world, embracing challenges, learning from failures, and seeking feedback are key to success.

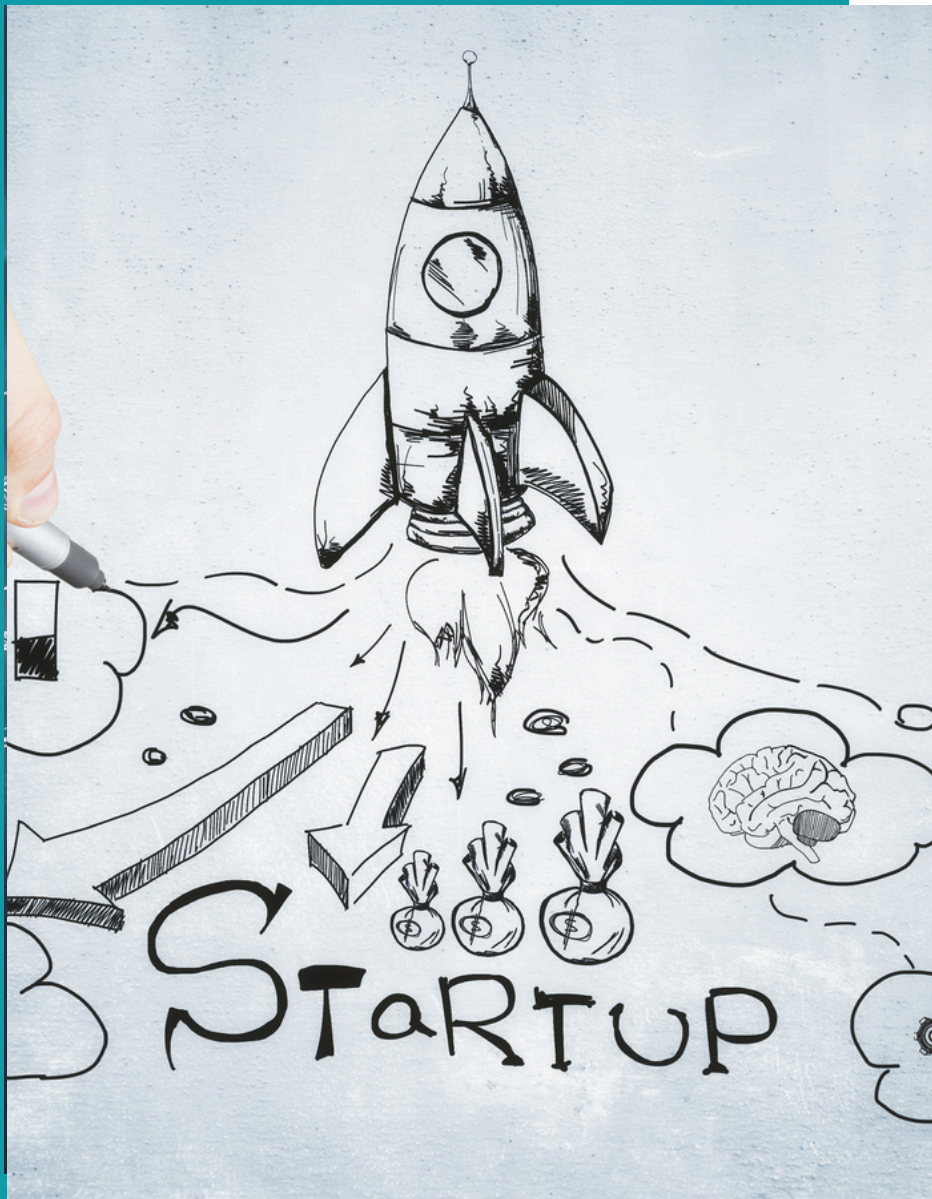
Entrepreneurs are like detectives, they always look for gaps in the market that they can fill with innovative solutions. By keenly observing consumer needs and trends, they can create products or services that make a real impact.



There are many challenges faced by entrepreneurs, some of them are financial constraints and funding, risk management, and decision making. Money matters can make or break an entrepreneur's dreams. Navigating through financial constraints and securing funding can be a rollercoaster ride, but it's all part of the entrepreneurial journey towards building a sustainable business. Entrepreneurs are like chess players, constantly strategizing and making calculated moves. Managing risks, making tough decisions, and staying agile in the face of uncertainty are all part and parcel of the entrepreneurial hustle.

There are many impacts of entrepreneurship, some of them are Job Creation, Economic Growth, Social Innovation and community development. Entrepreneurs are the unsung heroes of job creation, driving economic growth and prosperity. By starting businesses, they not only create employment opportunities but also stimulate innovation and contribute to the overall economic landscape.





Entrepreneurship isn't just about profits, it's about creating a positive impact on society. Socially conscious entrepreneurs focus on addressing pressing social issues, promoting sustainability, and championing community development, leaving a legacy beyond mere business success. Some of the key traits of successful entrepreneurs are resilience and adaptability, vision and creativity, resources and support for entrepreneurs, networking and mentorship, and access to incubators and accelerators.

There are some Innovations and Trends in Entrepreneurship, they are E-commerce, Digital Marketing, and Sustainability and Social Entrepreneurship. In today's digital age, E-commerce is the new frontier for entrepreneurs. From selling handmade crafts on Etsy to running a global empire on Amazon, the possibilities are limitless. Digital marketing is the secret sauce that helps entrepreneurs reach their target audience, build brand awareness, and drive sales in the online realm. It's like having a virtual megaphone to shout your business from the rooftops.

Gone are the days of business as usual. Entrepreneurs today are not just in it for the profits but also for the planet and the people. Sustainability and social entrepreneurship are the buzzwords of the hour, with social impact initiatives becoming key drivers of success. It's not just about making money; it's about making a difference in the world.



As we conclude this discussion on entrepreneurship, it becomes evident that the entrepreneurial journey is not merely about starting a business; it is a transformative experience that shapes individuals and communities alike.

By fostering a growth mindset, leveraging opportunities, and overcoming challenges with resilience, entrepreneurs play a pivotal role in driving innovation and driving positive change. As the entrepreneurial landscape continues to evolve, aspiring business leaders find inspiration in the stories shared, and may they embark on their entrepreneurial endeavours with passion and purpose.

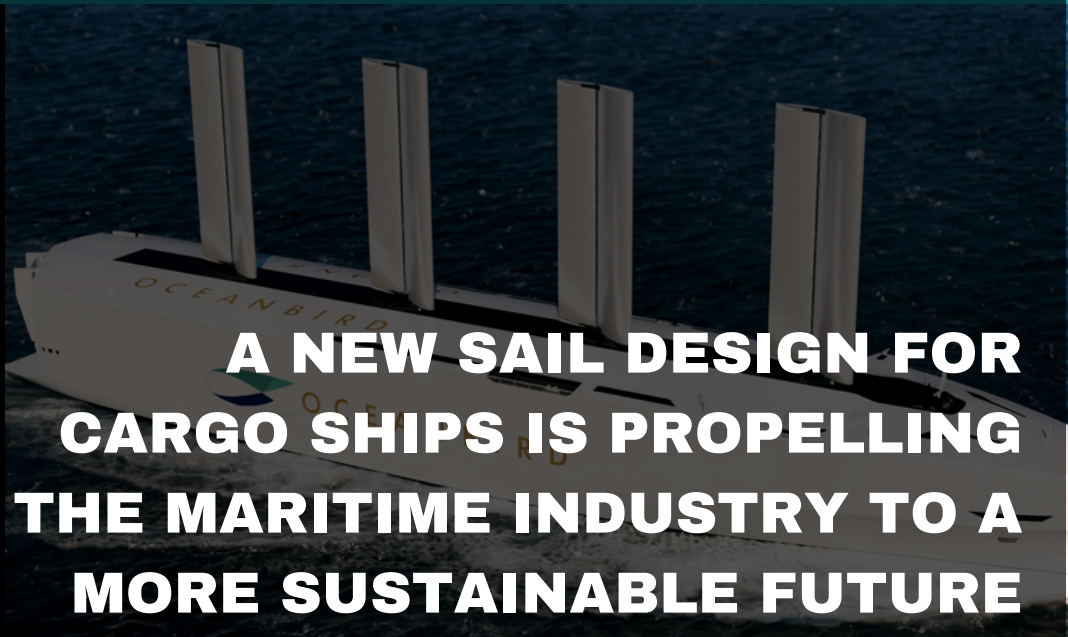


BUSINESS UPDATES

**APPLE ANNOUNCES
PARTNERSHIP
WITH OPENAI
INTEGRATING CHATGPT**



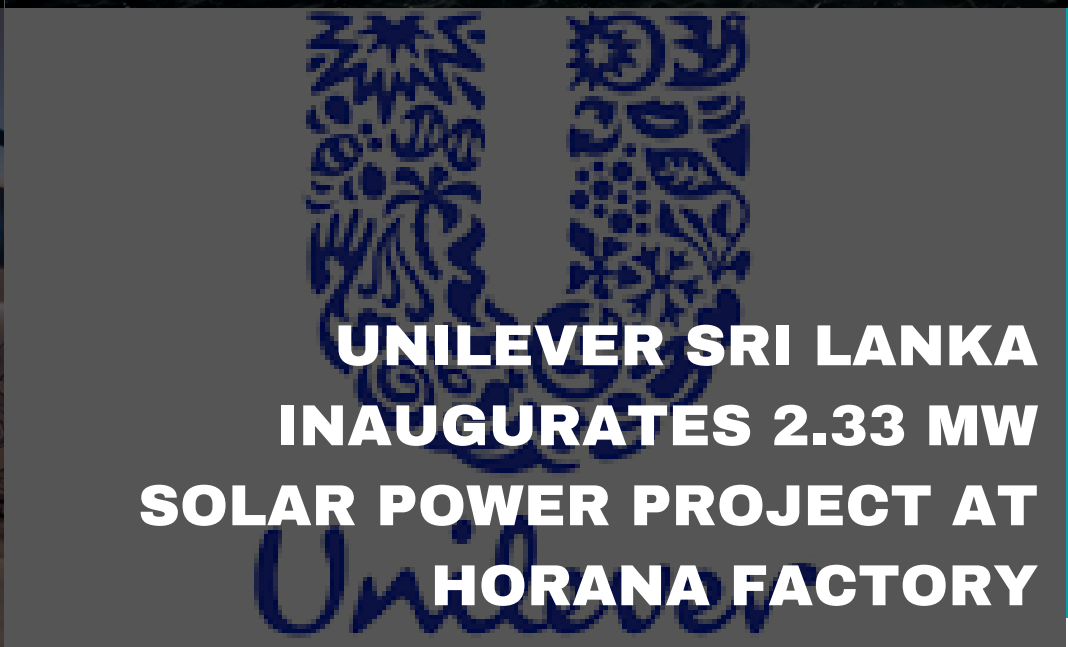
**A NEW SAIL DESIGN FOR
CARGO SHIPS IS PROPELLING
THE MARITIME INDUSTRY TO A
MORE SUSTAINABLE FUTURE**



**CHINA'S LUCKIN COFFEE IS
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AND BEATING STARBUCKS**



**UNILEVER SRI LANKA
INAUGURATES 2.33 MW
SOLAR POWER PROJECT AT
HORANA FACTORY**

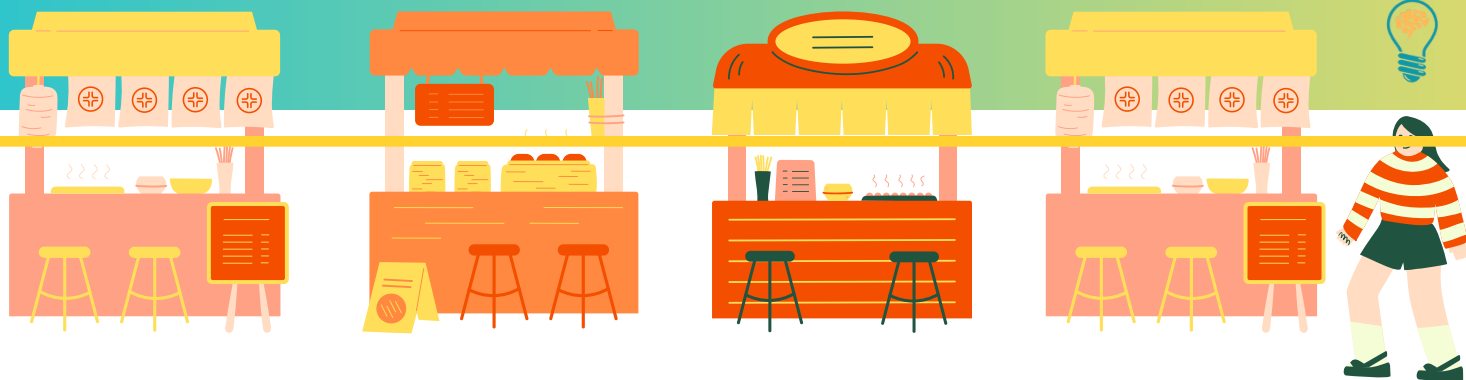


THANK YOU!!

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FOLLOWERS ON INSTAGRAM

Thank You For Your Support

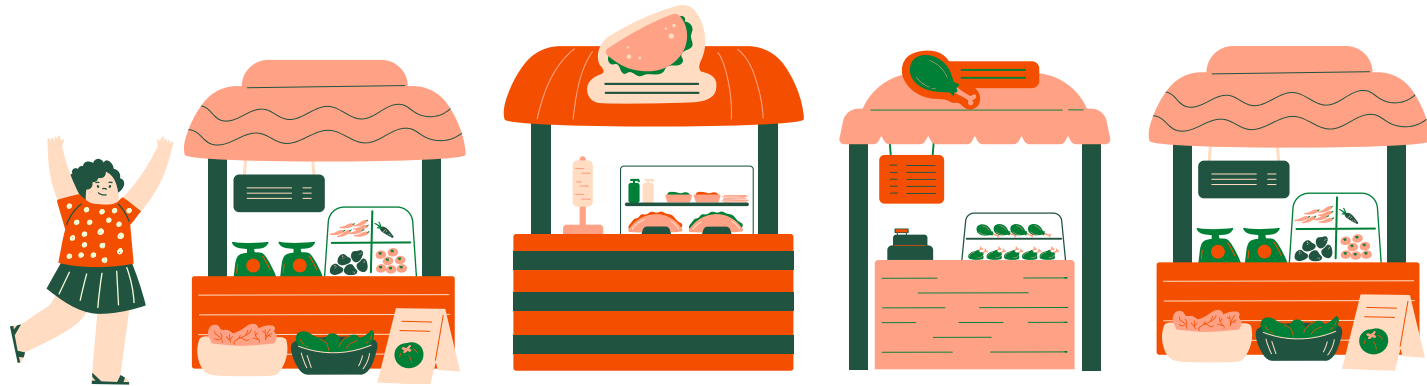


CALLING ALL STUDENT ENTREPRENEURS!

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SUBMIT YOUR WORK TO ECLUB@APIIT.LK

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